

By the end of this second trimester, your baby has doubled her weight, and the major organs continue to develop apace. You will look obviously pregnant now, and are likely to feel a calm sense of well-being.

19 WEEKS You are almost halfway through your journey. Congratulations!



Baby watch

📏 6½ in (16.4 cm) ⚖️ 10½ oz (300 g)

The legs are longer than the arms, and areas of hard bone continue to form. Your baby's senses of sight, sound, taste, touch, and smell are developing in the brain.

Mom matters

Your weight gain accelerates in this trimester. On average, women gain 1–2 lb (0.5–1 kg) per week from now up until delivery. Your baby accounts for only some of this extra weight; the rest is increased blood volume, breast size, amniotic fluid, and fat reserves. As your uterus continues to move upward, pressing into the stomach, and progesterone relaxes the abdominal muscles, digestion can become sluggish. You may suffer from heartburn, indigestion, and constipation, or existing symptoms may worsen.



This week...

» Include plenty of fiber in your diet and drink plenty of fluids to help keep your stool soft and avoid uncomfortable constipation.

» Start thinking about baby names, and compile a list of your favorites.

20 WEEKS Your ultrasound gives you a glimpse of your well-formed baby.



Baby watch

📏 10½ in (26.7 cm) ⚖️ 12¼ oz (360 g)

The skin is covered in fine, downy lanugo hair and fat is beginning to be deposited under the skin. The skin forms two distinct layers: the epidermis and the dermis. Your baby is regularly swallowing more amniotic fluid, the kidneys are processing this, and she is urinating. Your baby's skin begins to release a white, waxy substance called "vernix caseosa," which forms a protective coating on the skin.

Mom matters

Your belly is increasingly rounded; it sits just below your belly button. Your extra blood volume helps supply the organs, which are working harder now to support you and your baby.



This week...

» You will be given an anatomy scan (ultrasound) between 18 and 22 weeks. This takes various key measurements of your baby and checks her organs and body systems, and you can ask the sonographer to reveal your baby's gender if you want. The position of your placenta will also be checked.

21 WEEKS You are becoming more aware of your lively baby.



Baby watch

📏 10 in (27.8 cm) ⚖️ 15 oz (430 g)

The nerves and tiny bones in your baby's inner ear are developed enough for her to detect sounds. As the nervous system develops, your baby's movements become more deliberate: she kicks and may suck her thumb.

Mom matters

A large proportion of your increased blood volume is sent to your uterus, and this change in the distribution of your blood can make you feel dizzy at times. Your baby's movements become more obvious. Once you become aware of your baby's pattern of movement (rather than the actual number of movements), this becomes a good indicator of fetal well-being. If you don't feel any movement for 24 hours, contact your doctor.



This week...

» This is an ideal time to go on a "babymoon" vacation, before you're in your third trimester.

» Continue to eat a healthy diet, and avoid fatty, rich foods to counter indigestion.

22 WEEKS You may see some unwanted, though usually temporary, side effects.



Baby watch

📏 11 in (28.9 cm) ⚖️ 1.1 lb (501 g)

Bathed in amniotic fluid and with just a little subcutaneous fat, your baby looks a little wrinkly. The skin cells start to produce a protective layer of keratin. Tiny nails start to emerge at the base of the nail beds, hair might be appearing on the scalp, and your baby now has eyelashes and eyebrows.

Mom matters

As the uterus expands, thinning the skin's collagen and elastin fibers, stretch marks may appear. These fade from red or dark purple to a shiny, paler color after pregnancy. Your skin may feel very dry and itchy. Keeping hydrated and using an unperfumed moisturizer can help. Painful leg-muscle cramps are a common symptom during this time, with spasms often occurring at night. Flexing the foot and massage can relieve cramps.



This week...

» Anecdotally, foods containing potassium (such as bananas) or calcium may help to reduce the incidence of cramps. Staying well hydrated also helps prevent them.